international conference, not in honor of him. To celebrate his birthday, Wheeler set off a string of firecrackers behind his banquet chair, creating chaos amongst the nearby diners.

5. In the late 1980s it became clear that the laws of quantum mechanics can give rise to additional conserved quantities, associated with "quantum fields" (a type of field discussed in Chapter 12); and since these quantities, like a hole's mass, spin, and electric charge, cannot be radiated, they will remain as "quantum hair" when a black hole is born. Although this quantum hair might strongly influence the final fate of a microscopic, evaporating black hole (Chapter 12), it is of no consequence for the macroscopic holes (holes weighing more than the Sun) of this and the next few chapters, since quantum mechanics is generally unimportant on macroscopic scales.

6. A significant, mathematical piece of the proof of stability was provided, independently, by Steven Detweiler and James Ipser at Chicago, and a missing piece of the proof was supplied a year later by James Hartle and Dan Wilkins at the University of California at Santa Barbara.

7. Chandrasekhar was supposed to give me a subscription to *Playboy* as my reward, but my feminist mother and sisters made me feel so guilty that I requested instead a subscription to *The Listener*